

Growing concerns of racial profiling

Immigrant advocates say people, including legal residents, are being targeted based on their skin color.

By Brittney Mejia and Rachel Uranga

Brian Gavidia had stepped out from working on a car at a tow yard in a Los Angeles suburb Thursday when armed, masked men — wearing vests with “Border Patrol” on them — pushed him up against a metal gate and demanded to know where he was born.

“I’m American, bro!” 29-year-old Gavidia pleaded, in video taken by a friend.

“What hospital were you born?” the agent barked.

“I don’t know, dawg!” he said. “East L.A., bro! I can show you: I have my f— Real ID.”

His friend, whom Gavidia did not name, narrated the video: “These guys, literally based off of skin color! My homie was born here!” The friend said Gavidia was being questioned “just because of the way he looks.”

In a statement Saturday, Homeland Security Assistant Secretary Tricia McLaughlin said U.S. citizens were arrested “because they ASSAULTED U.S. Border Patrol Agents.” (McLaughlin’s statement emphasized the word “assaulted” in all-capital and boldfaced letters.)

When told by a reporter that Gavidia had not been arrested, McLaughlin clarified that Gavidia had been questioned by Border Patrol agents but there “is no arrest record.” She said a friend of Gavidia’s was arrested for assault of an officer.

As immigration operations have unfolded across Southern California in the last week, lawyers and advocates say people are being targeted because of their skin color. The encounters with Gavidia and others they are tracking have [See **Profiling**, A7]



GINA FERAZZI Los Angeles Times

ICE AGENTS detain a protester accused of throwing objects outside a federal building in L.A. last week.

Immigrant protests, tensions in L.A. reverberate in Mexico

Sheinbaum defends the demonstrators, placating her citizenry, which has been transfixed by coverage of city’s raids and rallies

By Patrick J. McDonnell

MEXICO CITY — The action may be on the streets of Los Angeles, but fallout from the immigrant protests is roiling politics in Mexico at a delicate moment — days before Mexican President Claudia Sheinbaum is expected to meet President Trump in their much-anticipated inaugural face-to-face encounter.

Sheinbaum has been on the defensive since Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem — at an Oval Office event in Trump’s presence — accused the Mexican president on Tuesday of “encouraging violent protests.”

While Sheinbaum has assailed the U.S. immigration raids and backed immigrants’ rights to protest, there is no public record of [See **Mexico**, A7]



MARCO UGARTE Associated Press

MEXICAN President Claudia Sheinbaum has had to face a delicate balancing act.

Raids by ICE are stunning but no surprise

Angelenos staggered by speed and severity of mass deportations, though Trump agenda was clear from outset.

By Jenny Jarvie and Grace Toohey

The threats weren’t subtle.

President Trump promised throughout his campaign that he would conduct the largest mass deportation in U.S. history. Migrants, he said, were “poisoning the blood” of the country and “getting them out will be a bloody story.”

“If I thought things were getting out of control,” the GOP candidate told Time magazine, “I would have no problem using the military.”

So it was perhaps inevitable, then, that after Trump was elected, the federal government was set for a historic showdown with the self-identified “sanctuary city” of Los Angeles, the vast metropolis where 1 in 3 residents is an immigrant.

L.A. County — home to 800,000 undocumented immigrants — has one of the nation’s most robust immigration rights networks. And these community groups were hosting “Know Your Rights” workshops, organizing patrols to alert residents of immigration sweeps and preparing, as much as they could, to resist.

Both sides had been building toward this moment for years — a city famous for embracing the immigrant experience and a White House that had made hostility toward those here illegally a hallmark of its agenda.

The upheaval last week on the streets of Los Angeles — immigration raids sweeping up workers and leaving communities in terror, scat- [See **Agenda**, A6]

Israel, Iran keep up bombardment

Trump warns Tehran against retaliating after it blamed U.S. in attacks

By NABIH BULOS

BEIRUT — Iran and Israel traded air raids and ballistic missile barrages overnight and into the evening Sunday, with neither side showing any inclination to back down from an escalating grudge match between the two longtime enemies.

The fighting, which came after Israel launched withering attacks Friday decapitating Iran’s top military leadership and hitting its nuclear infrastructure, killed at least 128 people in Iran on Friday and Saturday and wounded nearly 1,000 others, according to the Iranian government.

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian accused the United States of giving Israel the “green light” for the operation. [See **Mideast**, A4]



AMIR KHOLOUSI Iranian Students’ News Agency

IRANIANS assist a man injured in an explosion in downtown Tehran on Sunday.

Eaton fire could hit most electricity bills

California officials consider extending monthly surcharge at three major utilities to bolster state fund.

By Melody Petersen

More than 30 million Californians across the state could see their electric bills go up to pay for the devastating Eaton fire, as officials scramble to shore up a state wildfire fund that could be wiped out by damage claims.

One early estimate places fire losses from the Eaton fire at \$24 billion to \$45 billion. If Southern California Edison equipment is found to have sparked the blaze on Jan. 7, as dozens of

lawsuits allege, the damage claims could quickly exhaust the state’s \$21-billion wildfire fund.

“Everyone is concerned about this,” said Michael Wara, director of Stanford’s climate and energy policy program, who was involved in the fund’s creation. “If we need to put more money into the fund, where will it come from?”

The wildfire fund was created to shield the state’s three big utilities from bankruptcy in the event one was found liable for massive fire damages.

At a meeting last month, members of the state Catastrophe Response Council, which oversees the fund, were told that Gov. Gavin Newsom and legislative leaders were being urged to [See **Surcharge**, A12]

Armenian gang war breaks out in Valley

A motorcyclist coasted to a stop on a sun-baked street in the San Fernando Valley.

He retrieved a stepladder from the bed of a pickup truck and leaned it against a high metal fence that encircled a two-story house.

Observing the late afternoon scene was a man who lived next door to the fenced-off home. The neighbor, who declined to be named for fear of retaliation, told The Times he watched in disbelief as the motorcyclist — still wear-

A power struggle to become boss in L.A. leads to shootings and kidnappings, authorities say

By Matthew Ormseth

ing a helmet — climbed up the ladder and opened fire with a rifle.

According to federal authorities, the neighbor had witnessed a salvo in a war between rival crews of Armenian criminals. The target of the attempted hit on Aug. 18, 2023, was Vahan Harutyunyan, a convicted fraud artist and money launderer, a federal agent wrote in an affidavit.

The affidavit describes a violent turn within Armenian organized crime [See **Gang war**, A8]

Minnesota on edge amid manhunt
Authorities search a vehicle they believe was used by the suspect in shooting of legislators. **NATION, A5**

The private side of a space legend
New documentary tells the story of astronaut Sally Ride and her partner. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Weather
Sunny and very warm. L.A. Basin: 84/63. **B6**

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National anthem of solidarity
Nezza says her Spanish rendition in support of protesters defied Dodgers’ wishes. **SPORTS, D5**

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